I Can solve two-step stories

CCSS 3.OA.D.8 · **EE** M.EE.3.OA.7 · **CRA:** Pictorial → Abstract · **Flow:** Standard (2 new routine steps)

Lesson guidance:

Tip: Two boxes, two steps. Point at the Step 1 box, then the Step 2 box, every time you read a story.

Tip: "Each". "Each bag has 6" means every bag has 6: equal groups. Act it out with cups.

Watch: A story number in Step 2. The mistake to stop today: Step 2 done with a story number. Draw the arrow from the Step 1 answer.

Lesson flow:

#	Section	Pupil page	Min
1	Prerequisite Check	Prerequisite Check	5
2	Number sense	Number sense	4
3	Spaced retrieval	Mini whiteboards	3
4	Chaining bridge	Mini whiteboards	2
5a	I Do 1: groups first	Anchor chart 1	6
6a	We Do 1: Guided Practice	Lesson sheet 1	5
5b	I Do 2: share first	Anchor chart 2	5
6b	We Do 2: Guided Practice	Lesson sheet 2	5
7	Check Question	Mini whiteboards	3
8	You Do: Independent Practice	Practice 1–2	9
9	Word problem	Word problem	5
10	Plenary and exit slip	Exit slip	4
	Transitions	between pages	4
	Total		**60**

Materials:

- ☐ Cups and counters, 6 cups and 60 counters per pair
- ☐ Anchor charts 1 and 2
- ☐ Exit slips, cut in half
- ☐ Mini whiteboards and pens
- ☐ Pupil packet, one per pupil

Vocabulary:

Step 1 → Step 2

step

one part of the work

3 bags of 4

each

every group has the same

6 − 2 = 4

left

what stays after some go

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What students need to know:

#	Skill or Concept	Atom Type	Teacher Notes
1	× facts to 10 × 10	Fact · Pre-requisite	Spaced retrieval, Section 3.
2	**Equal groups:** multiply	Category · Pre-requisite	Prerequisite Check 1.
3	**Share equally:** divide	Category · Pre-requisite	Prerequisite Check 2–3.
4	Two steps with + and −	Conceptual · Pre-requisite	Prerequisite Check 4.
5	"Each" names Step 1	Category	The first two lines are Step 1.
6	**Step 1 answer: a Step 2 number**	**Conceptual**	**Critical Atom. Draw the arrow into Step 2.**
7	Two steps or one step	Comparative	Is the Step 1 answer the question?
8	**Gives away:** −. Gets more: +.	Category	The third line is Step 2.

What students do:

Step	Task / Routine atom	Tag	Check it with
1	Read it. What do I find first?	New	Guided cell 1
2	Step 1: the groups or the share. × or ÷.	Pre-requisite	Prerequisite Check 1–2
3	**Step 2: use my Step 1 answer.**	**New**	**Check Question; exit slip 1**
4	Write the answer and the unit.	Pre-requisite	Practice 1 and 2

Rows tagged New: 2 → Flow: Standard. Chunk 1 (5a, 6a): × first. Chunk 2 (5b, 6b): ÷ first. Step 2 is always + or −.

How to teach:

1. Cups and counters first: the groups, then take some away or add some.
2. Then the two step boxes: the Step 1 answer is copied into Step 2 with an arrow.
3. Chunk 1 is × first; chunk 2 is ÷ first. Step 2 is + or − every time.
4. Do not hunt key words: ask "What do I find first?"

Board: Two boxes: Step 1 5 × 9 = 45 → Step 2 45 − 31 = 14.

Common mistakes:

Mistake	Step	Looks like	Fix	Caught by
Stops after Step 1	3	27	"Is that the question? Read the last line."	Check Question A, Exit 1
Story number in Step 2	3	2	Arrow: the Step 1 answer goes into Step 2.	Check Question B, Exit 2
One sign for all	2	5	"How many steps?" Count the boxes.	Check Question C

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Reference key:

Pages and order

Page	Tab	Score
P0	Prerequisite	one per question
P1	Number sense	/10
P2	Anchor chart	none (a poster)
P3	Lesson 1	Guided: not scored
P4	Practice n	every cell
P5	Word problem	/1
P6	Exit slip	/2 a half
T1–T5	Teacher n	—
T6	Answer Key	—

Fade levels

Label	Means
★	Guided: hints on, step 1 traced
★★	Independent: hints off
★★★	Last row: the edge cases

Data loop

● **Most:**	Go on.
◑ **About half:**	Short reteach, then go on.
○ **Fewer than half:**	Stop. Reteach with a concrete example.

Abbreviations

Short	In full
MWBs	mini whiteboards
ELL	English language learners
SPED	special education students
RCDWS	Read, Circle, Draw, Write, Solve
CRA	Concrete-Representational-Abstract

Routing ids

3.OA.C.7 · 3.OA.A.3 · Y2 B4 S10 Two-step problems: the lessons P0 routes back to (T6).

Answer slots

Shape	Used for
_____	a number after =
☐	a part inside an expression
☐	a tick (routine panel, exit slip)
☐	a step box: Step 1 or Step 2
_____	P5: the answer on the story line

Icons

Icon	Means
	Tip
	Feedback
	Watch
	Research
	Critical Atom
	Language tip
	Why it works
	Board
	The pupil Steps (accent)

Band labels

Pupil: Vocabulary · Remember · Guided Practice · Steps · Independent Practice · Mixed Review · Number sense: A / B · Workspace · Another example · Say · Rule.

Teacher: Lesson guidance · Lesson flow · Materials · What students need to know · What students do · How to teach · Common mistakes · Section n · Prerequisite routing · Accepted answers · Answers at a glance.

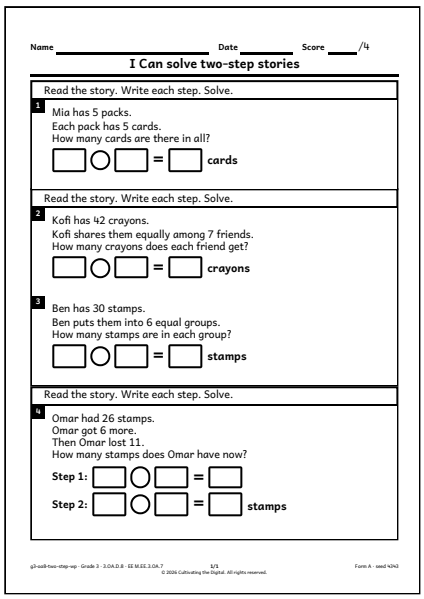
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Section 1 · Prerequisite Check (5 min)

Tip: Route before teaching. Mark it while pupils do the Number sense page.

1. **Do:** Hand out the Prerequisite Check, face down.
2. **Say:** "Do these on your own. Try every one."
3. **Do:** Read each story aloud. Walk and mark.
   Note: Expected: **1. 25 · 2. 6 · 3. 5 · 4. 21**. Routing is on T6.



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Read the story. Write each step. Solve.

1. Mia has 5 packs.
Each pack has 5 cards.
How many cards are there in all?
□ ○ □ = □ cards

Read the story. Write each step. Solve.

2. Kofi has 42 crayons.
Kofi shares them equally among 7 friends.
How many crayons does each friend get?
□ ○ □ = □ crayons

3. Ben has 30 stamps.
Ben puts them into 6 equal groups.
How many stamps are in each group?
□ ○ □ = □ stamps

Read the story. Write each step. Solve.

4. Omar had 26 stamps.
Omar got 6 more.
Then Omar lost 11.
How many stamps does Omar have now?
Step 1: □ ○ □ = □
Step 2: □ ○ □ = □ stamps

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Section 2 · Number sense (4 min)

1. **Do:** Hand out the Number sense page. Band A first.
2. **Say:** "Read each row. Write the answer."
3. **Do:** Early finishers go on to band B.
   Note: Band A: **57** · **10** · **>** · **3 tens 9 ones** · **34**.

Section 3 · Spaced retrieval (3 min)

1. **Do:** Pupils hold mini whiteboards. Write each question on the board.
2. **Ask:** "4 × 5 = ?"
   Note: Expected: **20**.
3. **Ask:** "18 ÷ 3 = ?"
   Note: Expected: **6**.
4. **Ask:** "12 − 7 = ?"
   Note: Expected: **5**.

Section 4 · Chaining bridge (2 min)

1. **Say:** "You can solve a story with one step."
2. **Say:** "Today: two steps. Step 2 uses the Step 1 answer."

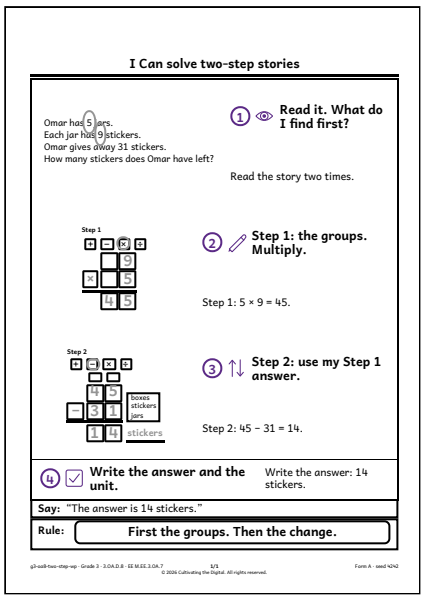
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Section 5a · I Do 1: groups first (6 min)

Watch: Step 1 is not the answer. Stop on the Step 1 answer and ask: "Is that the question?"

1	**Do:**	Put anchor chart 1 up. Read the story two times.
2	**Say:**	"What do I find first? The groups."
	Note:	Step 1. Show 5 cups of 9 counters.
3	**Say:**	"Step 1: 5 × 9 = 45."
	Note:	Write it in the Step 1 box: **45**.
4	**Say:**	"Is 45 the question? No. Step 2."
	Note:	Read the last line again.
5	**Say:**	"Step 2 uses my Step 1 answer: 45 − 31 = 14."
	Note:	Draw the arrow from **45** into Step 2.
6	**Ask:**	"How many stickers does Omar have left?"
	Note:	Expected: **14** stickers.
7	**Say:**	"Gets more? Step 2 is +."
	Note:	Write on the board: Zara has 3 plates. Each plate has 5 beads. Zara gets 10 more beads. How many beads does Zara have now? Step 1 **3 × 5 = 15**, Step 2 **15 + 10 = 25**.


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Omar has 5 jars.
Each jar has 9 stickers.
Omar gives away 31 stickers.
How many stickers does Omar have left?

1 Read it. What do I find first?

Read the story two times.

Step 1

2 Step 1: the groups. Multiply.

Step 1: 5 × 9 = 45.

Step 2

boxes
stickers
jars

3 Step 2: use my Step 1 answer.

Step 2: 45 − 31 = 14.

4 Write the answer and the unit.

Write the answer: 14 stickers.

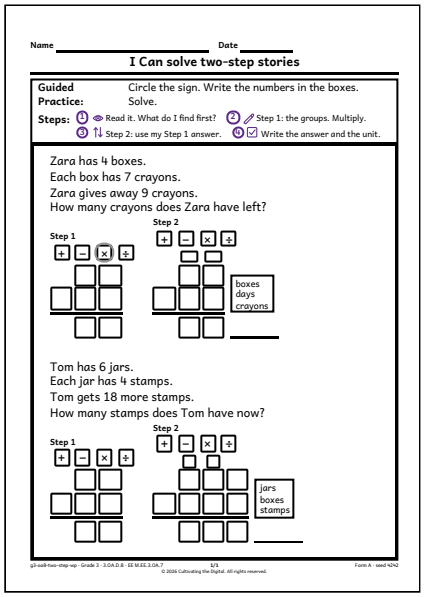
Say: "The answer is 14 stickers."

Rule: First the groups. Then the change.

Section 6a · We Do 1: Guided Practice (5 min)

Feedback: Fix it at once. Fix: point to the Step 1 box. "Where does this number go next?"

1	**Say:**	"Cell 1: the Step 1 sign is done in grey."
	Note:	Step 1 **4 × 7 = 28**; Step 2 **28 − 9 = 19**.
2	**Ask:**	"Which number goes into Step 2 first?"
	Note:	Expected: the Step 1 answer, **28**.
3	**Do:**	Pairs do cell 2: A reads, B points to each box.
	Note:	Expected: **6 × 4 = 24**, then **24 + 18 = 42** stamps.
4	**Ask:**	"Cell 2: which sign is Step 2? How do you know?"
	Note:	Expected: **+**. The third line tells: gets more is +, gives away is −.
5	**Do:**	A pupil who stops after Step 1: point to the last line.
	Note:	Read the question aloud together. Is the Step 1 answer the question?
6	**Ask:**	"Where did your Step 1 answer go?"
	Note:	Pupils point: the top row of Step 2.
7	**Say:**	"First the groups. Then the change."
	Note:	The chant. Say it twice together.


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Guided Practice: Circle the sign. Write the numbers in the boxes. Solve.

Steps: 1 Read it. What do I find first? 2 Step 1: the groups. Multiply. 3 Step 2: use my Step 1 answer. 4 Write the answer and the unit.

Zara has 4 boxes.
Each box has 7 crayons.
Zara gives away 9 crayons.
How many crayons does Zara have left?

Step 1 Step 2

boxes
days
crayons

Tom has 6 jars.
Each jar has 4 stamps.
Tom gets 18 more stamps.
How many stamps does Tom have now?

Step 1 Step 2

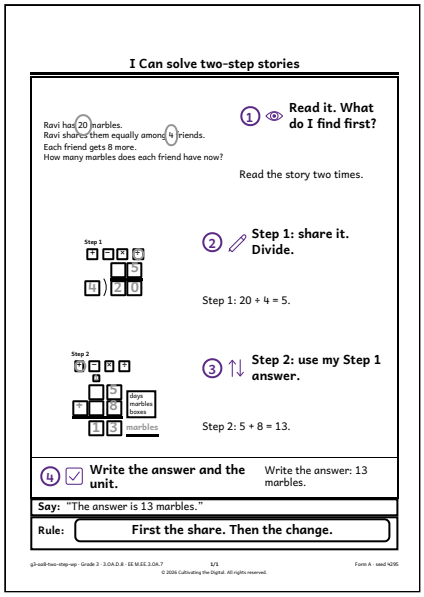
jars
boxes
stamps

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Section 5b · I Do 2: share first (5 min)

Tip: "Shares equally". Act it out: deal the counters one at a time into the cups.

1. **Do:** Put anchor chart 2 up. Read the story two times.
2. **Say:** "What do I find first? One share."
   Note: Deal 20 counters into 4 cups.
3. **Say:** "Step 1: 20 ÷ 4 = 5."
   Note: Each friend has **5**.
4. **Say:** "Step 2 uses my Step 1 answer: 5 + 8 = 13."
   Note: The change is to ONE share, not to 20.
5. **Ask:** "How many marbles does each friend have now?"
   Note: Expected: **13** marbles.


I Can solve two-step stories

Ravi has 20 marbles.
Ravi shares them equally among 4 friends.
Each friend gets 8 more.
How many marbles does each friend have now?

1 Read it. What do I find first?

Read the story two times.

2 Step 1: share it. Divide.

Step 1: 20 ÷ 4 = 5.

3 Step 2: use my Step 1 answer.

Step 2: 5 + 8 = 13.

4 Write the answer and the unit.

Write the answer: 13 marbles.

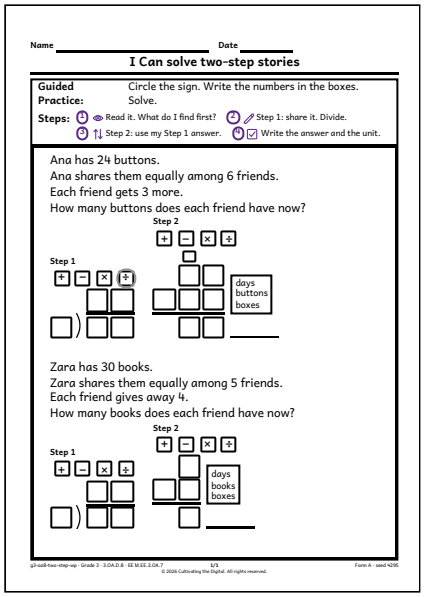
Say: "The answer is 13 marbles."

Rule: First the share. Then the change.

Section 6b · We Do 2: Guided Practice (5 min)

Feedback: Change to the total. A pupil who changes the total: "Is that one friend's share?"

1. **Say:** "Cell 1: share first."
   Note: Step 1 **24 ÷ 6 = 4**; Step 2 **4 + 3 = 7**.
2. **Do:** Pupils do cell 2 on their own.
   Note: Expected: **30 ÷ 5 = 6**, then **6 − 4 = 2**.
3. **Say:** "First the share. Then the change."
   Note: The chant. Say it twice together.


Name _____ Date _____

I Can solve two-step stories

Guided Practice: Circle the sign. Write the numbers in the boxes. Solve.

Steps: 1 Read it. What do I find first? 2 Step 1: share it. Divide. 3 Step 2: use my Step 1 answer. 4 Write the answer and the unit.

Ana has 24 buttons.
Ana shares them equally among 6 friends.
Each friend gets 3 more.
How many buttons does each friend have now?

Step 1 Step 2 days buttons boxes

Zara has 30 books.
Zara shares them equally among 5 friends.
Each friend gives away 4.
How many books does each friend have now?

Step 1 Step 2 days books boxes

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Section 7 · Check Question (3 min)

1. **Do:** Read the story on the board: Tom has 3 jars. Each jar has 9 stamps. Tom gives away 7 stamps. How many stamps does Tom have left?

2. **Do:** Write four answers. A: 27 · B: 2 · C: 5 · D: 20.

3. **Ask:** "Which answer is right? Show fingers."
   Note: Correct: **D 20**. A: Stops after Step 1 · B: Story number in Step 2 · C: One sign for all

- ● **Most:** Go on to You Do.
- ◑ **About half:** Redo one story with cups and counters, then two more.
- ○ **Fewer than half:** Stop. Cups again with two stories. Point to each step box.

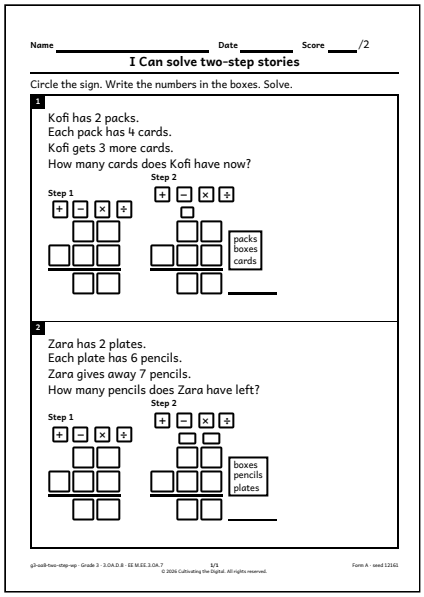
Section 8 · You Do: Independent Practice (9 min)

Watch: The last row. Walk to the last rows first: Practice 1: 5 (the Step 2 number bigger than both Step 1 numbers); Practice 2: 11 (the Step 2 number bigger than both Step 1 numbers).

1. **Do:** Pupils do Practice 1 (× first), then Practice 2 (÷ first). The Steps are on the anchor chart.

2. **Do:** Visit ELL and SPED pupils first, within 60 seconds.

3. **Ask:** "Point to your Step 1 answer. Where did it go?"
   Note: Praise: "You used your Step 1 answer. That is step 3."



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I Can solve two-step stories

Circle the sign. Write the numbers in the boxes. Solve.

1. Kofi has 2 packs.
Each pack has 4 cards.
Kofi gets 3 more cards.
How many cards does Kofi have now?

Step 1 + − × ÷ Step 2 + − × ÷

packs boxes cards

2. Zara has 2 plates.
Each plate has 6 pencils.
Zara gives away 7 pencils.
How many pencils does Zara have left?

Step 1 + − × ÷ Step 2 + − × ÷

boxes pencils plates

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Section 9 · Word problem (5 min)

1. **Do:** Read the story aloud two times. Pupils tick each box.

2. **Say:** "No step boxes this time. Draw it. Write both steps."
   Note: Expected: Step 1 **5 × 7 = 35**; Step 2 **35 − 10 = 25** beads.

Section 10 · Plenary and exit slip (4 min)

1. **Say:** "First the groups. Then the change."
   Note: Say the chant together twice.

2. **Do:** Hand out the exit slip. No help. Sort the slips by the boxes ticked.
   Note: 1. **12** · 2. **10**.

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Name _____ Date _____ Score _____ /4

I Can solve two-step stories

Read the story. Write each step. Solve.

1

Mia has 5 packs.
Each pack has 5 cards.
How many cards are there in all?

□ ○ □ = □ **cards**

Read the story. Write each step. Solve.

2

Kofi has 42 crayons.
Kofi shares them equally among 7 friends.
How many crayons does each friend get?

□ ○ □ = □ **crayons**

3

Ben has 30 stamps.
Ben puts them into 6 equal groups.
How many stamps are in each group?

□ ○ □ = □ **stamps**

Read the story. Write each step. Solve.

4

Omar had 26 stamps.
Omar got 6 more.
Then Omar lost 11.
How many stamps does Omar have now?

Step 1: □ ○ □ = □

Step 2: □ ○ □ = □ **stamps**

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Name _____ Date _____ Score _____ /10

I Can solve two-step stories

Number sense: A

1	Write the missing number.	**10** more than **47** is _____ .
2	Write the missing number.	**10** less than **20** is _____ .
3	Write <, > or = in the circle.	**72** ◯ **35**
4	Write how many of each place.	**39** = ☐ tens ☐ ones
5	Write the missing number.	**1** more than **33** is _____ .

Number sense: B

6	Write the missing number.	**10** more than **877** is _____ .
7	Write the missing number.	**10** less than **305** is _____ .
8	Write <, > or = in the circle.	**544** ◯ **565**
9	Write how many of each place.	**84** = ☐ tens ☐ ones
10	Write the missing number.	**1** more than **103** is _____ .

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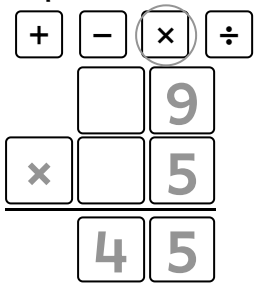
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Omar has 5 jars.
Each jar has 9 stickers.
Omar gives away 31 stickers.
How many stickers does Omar have left?

1 Read it. What do I find first?

Read the story two times.

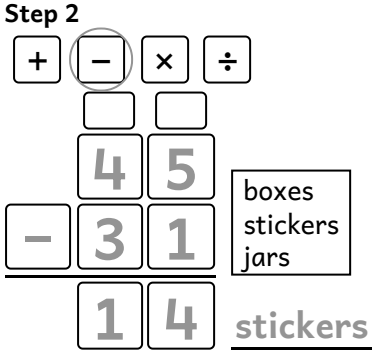
Step 1



2 Step 1: the groups. Multiply.

Step 1: 5 × 9 = 45.

Step 2



3 Step 2: use my Step 1 answer.

Step 2: 45 − 31 = 14.

4 Write the answer and the unit.

Write the answer: 14 stickers.

Say: "The answer is 14 stickers."

Rule: **First the groups. Then the change.**

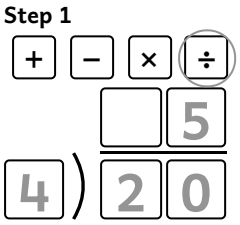
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Ravi has 20 marbles.
Ravi shares them equally among 4 friends.
Each friend gets 8 more.
How many marbles does each friend have now?

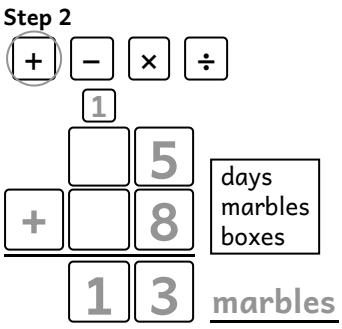
1 Read it. What do I find first?

Read the story two times.



2 Step 1: share it. Divide.

Step 1: 20 ÷ 4 = 5.



3 Step 2: use my Step 1 answer.

Step 2: 5 + 8 = 13.

4 Write the answer and the unit.

Write the answer: 13 marbles.

Say: "The answer is 13 marbles."

Rule: **First the share. Then the change.**

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Name _____ Date _____

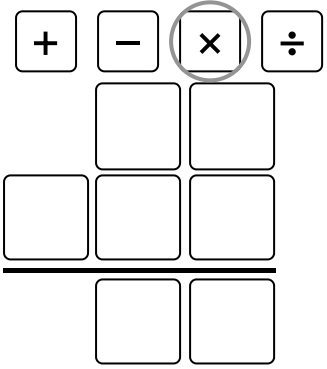
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Guided Practice: Circle the sign. Write the numbers in the boxes. Solve.

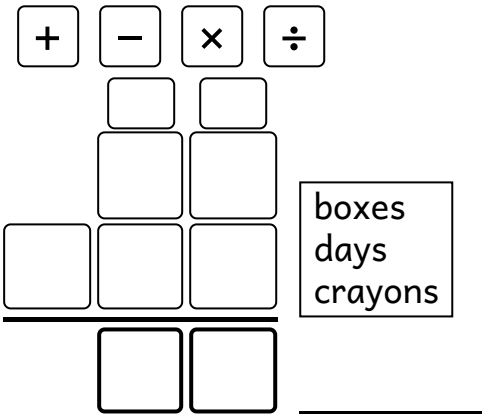
Steps: (1) Read it. What do I find first? (2) Step 1: the groups. Multiply.
(3) Step 2: use my Step 1 answer. (4) Write the answer and the unit.

Zara has 4 boxes.
Each box has 7 crayons.
Zara gives away 9 crayons.
How many crayons does Zara have left?

Step 1



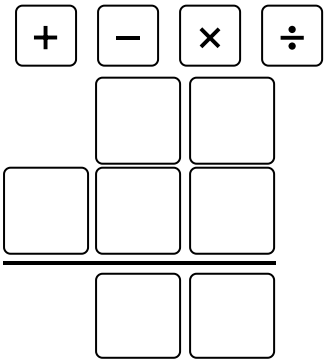
Step 2



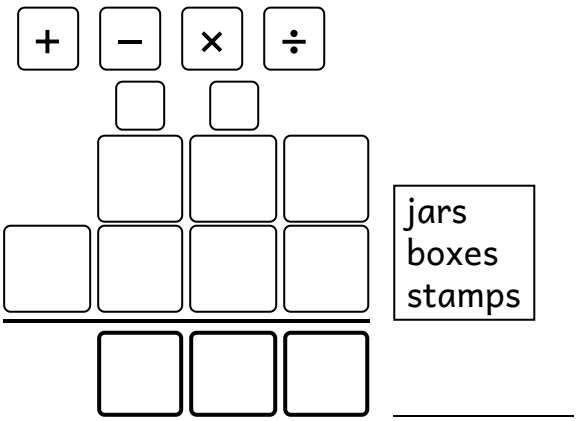
_____

Tom has 6 jars.
Each jar has 4 stamps.
Tom gets 18 more stamps.
How many stamps does Tom have now?

Step 1



Step 2



_____

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Name _____ Date _____

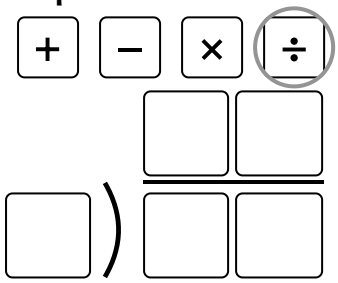
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Guided Practice: Circle the sign. Write the numbers in the boxes. Solve.

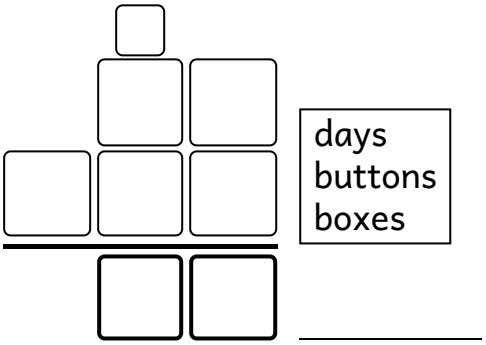
Steps: (1) Read it. What do I find first? (2) Step 1: share it. Divide.
(3) Step 2: use my Step 1 answer. (4) Write the answer and the unit.

Ana has 24 buttons.
Ana shares them equally among 6 friends.
Each friend gets 3 more.
How many buttons does each friend have now?

Step 1



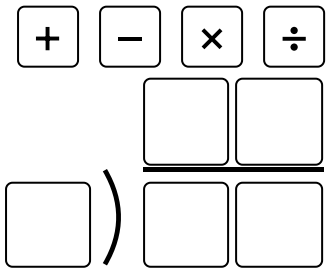
Step 2



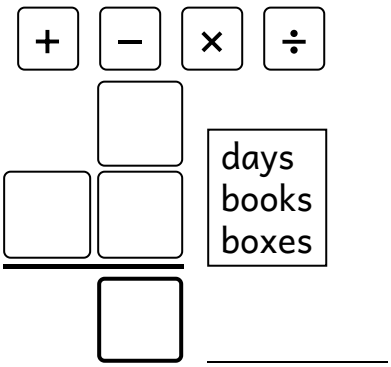
_____

Zara has 30 books.
Zara shares them equally among 5 friends.
Each friend gives away 4.
How many books does each friend have now?

Step 1



Step 2



_____

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Name _____ **Date** _____ **Score** _____ /2

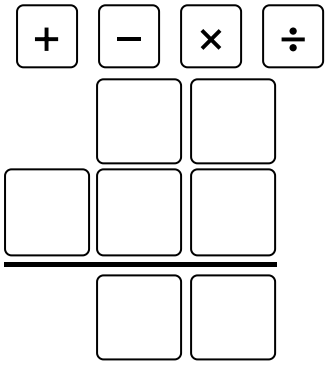
I Can solve two-step stories

Circle the sign. Write the numbers in the boxes. Solve.

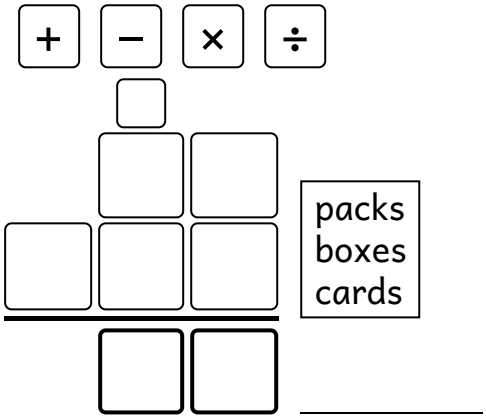
1

Kofi has 2 packs.
Each pack has 4 cards.
Kofi gets 3 more cards.
How many cards does Kofi have now?

Step 1



Step 2

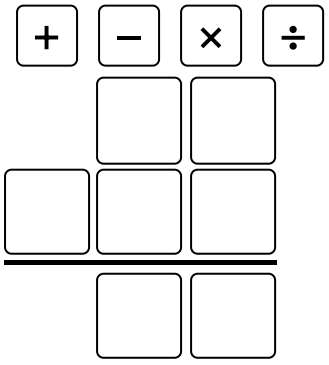


_____

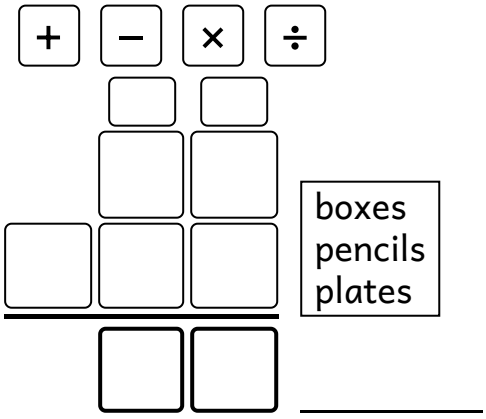
2

Zara has 2 plates.
Each plate has 6 pencils.
Zara gives away 7 pencils.
How many pencils does Zara have left?

Step 1



Step 2



_____

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Name _____ **Date** _____ **Score** _____ /2

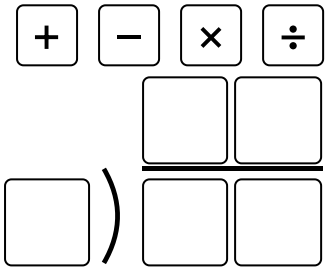
I Can solve two-step stories

Circle the sign. Write the numbers in the boxes. Solve.

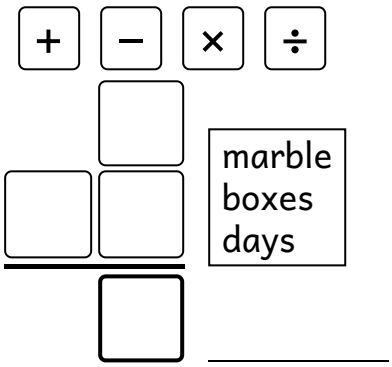
1

Tom has 20 marbles.
Tom shares them equally among 5 friends.
Each friend gives away 3.
How many marbles does each friend have now?

Step 1



Step 2

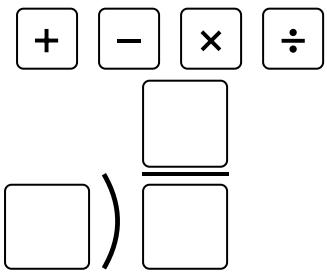


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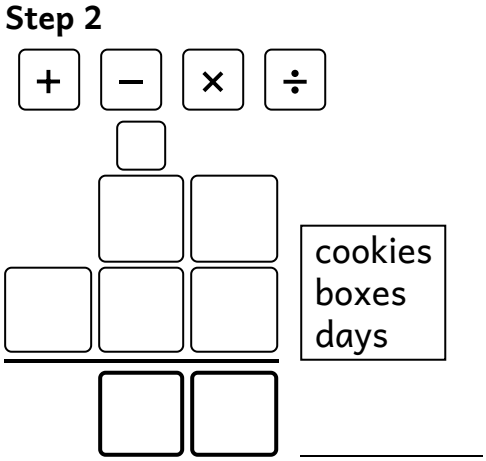
2

Kofi has 6 cookies.
Kofi shares them equally among 2 friends.
Each friend gets 8 more.
How many cookies does each friend have now?

Step 1



Step 2



_____

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Name _____ Date _____ Score _____ /1

I Can solve two-step stories

Read the story. Draw it. Solve.

Zara has 5 plates.

Each plate has 7 beads.

Zara gives away 10 beads.

How many beads are left?

The answer: _____ beads.

- ☐ Read it two times.
- ☐ Circle the numbers.
- ☐ Underline the question.
- ☐ Draw it.
- ☐ Write the equation.
- ☐ Solve. Check.

Workspace:

Step 1: ☐ ○ ☐ = ☐

Step 2: ☐ ○ ☐ = ☐

Say: "My Step 1 answer is _____. Then I take away."

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Name _____ Score _____ /2

I Can solve two-step stories

Read the story. Write each step. Solve.

1

Kofi has 2 boxes.
Each box has 8 books.
Kofi gives away 4 books.
How many books does Kofi have left?

Step 1: ☐ ◯ ☐ = ☐

Step 2: ☐ ◯ ☐ = ☐ **books**

2

Leo has 24 buttons.
Leo shares them equally among 3 friends.
Each friend gets 2 more.
How many buttons does each friend have now?

Step 1: ☐ ◯ ☐ = ☐

Step 2: ☐ ◯ ☐ = ☐ **buttons**

Say: "Step 2 uses my Step 1 _____."

☐ I can do this. ☐ I need one more day.

Name _____ Score _____ /2

I Can solve two-step stories

Read the story. Write each step. Solve.

1

Kofi has 2 boxes.
Each box has 8 books.
Kofi gives away 4 books.
How many books does Kofi have left?

Step 1: ☐ ◯ ☐ = ☐

Step 2: ☐ ◯ ☐ = ☐ books

2

Leo has 24 buttons.
Leo shares them equally among 3 friends.
Each friend gets 2 more.
How many buttons does each friend have now?

Step 1: ☐ ◯ ☐ = ☐

Step 2: ☐ ◯ ☐ = ☐ buttons

Say: "Step 2 uses my Step 1 _____."

☐ I can do this. ☐ I need one more day.

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Answer Key _____ Date _____ Score _____ /4

I Can solve two-step stories

Read the story. Write each step. Solve.

1

Mia has 5 packs.
Each pack has 5 cards.
How many cards are there in all?

5 × 5 = 25 **cards**

Read the story. Write each step. Solve.

2

Kofi has 42 crayons.
Kofi shares them equally among 7 friends.
How many crayons does each friend get?

42 ÷ 7 = 6 **crayons**

3

Ben has 30 stamps.
Ben puts them into 6 equal groups.
How many stamps are in each group?

30 ÷ 6 = 5 **stamps**

Read the story. Write each step. Solve.

4

Omar had 26 stamps.
Omar got 6 more.
Then Omar lost 11.
How many stamps does Omar have now?

Step 1: 26 + 6 = 32

Step 2: 32 − 11 = 21 **stamps**

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Answer Key _____ Date _____ Score _____ /10

I Can solve two-step stories

Number sense: A

1. Write the missing number.

10 more than **47** is **57** .

2. Write the missing number.

10 less than **20** is **10** .

3. Write <, > or = in the circle.

72 **>** **35**

4. Write how many of each place.

39 = **3** tens **9** ones

5. Write the missing number.

1 more than **33** is **34** .

Number sense: B

6. Write the missing number.

10 more than **877** is **887** .

7. Write the missing number.

10 less than **305** is **295** .

8. Write <, > or = in the circle.

544 **<** **565**

9. Write how many of each place.

84 = **8** tens **4** ones

10. Write the missing number.

1 more than **103** is **104** .

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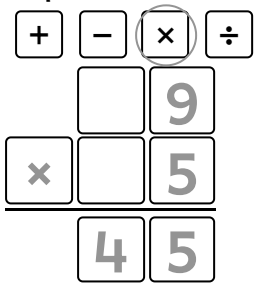
I Can solve two-step stories

Omar has 5 jars.
Each jar has 9 stickers.
Omar gives away 31 stickers.
How many stickers does Omar have left?

1 Read it. What do I find first?

Read the story two times.

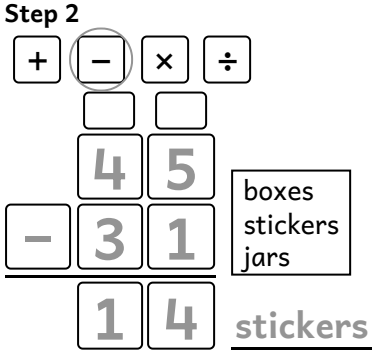
Step 1



2 Step 1: the groups. Multiply.

Step 1: 5 × 9 = 45.

Step 2



3 Step 2: use my Step 1 answer.

Step 2: 45 − 31 = 14.

4 Write the answer and the unit.

Write the answer: 14 stickers.

Say: "The answer is 14 stickers."

Rule: **First the groups. Then the change.**

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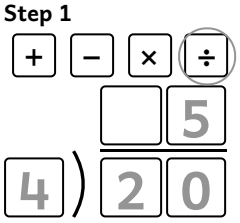
I Can solve two-step stories

Ravi has 20 marbles.
Ravi shares them equally among 4 friends.
Each friend gets 8 more.
How many marbles does each friend have now?

1 Read it. What do I find first?

Read the story two times.

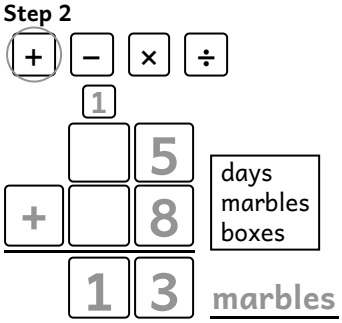
Step 1



2 Step 1: share it. Divide.

Step 1: 20 ÷ 4 = 5.

Step 2



3 Step 2: use my Step 1 answer.

Step 2: 5 + 8 = 13.

4 Write the answer and the unit.

Write the answer: 13 marbles.

Say: "The answer is 13 marbles."

Rule: **First the share. Then the change.**

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Answer Key _____ **Date** _____

I Can solve two-step stories

Guided Practice: Circle the sign. Write the numbers in the boxes. Solve.

Steps: (1) Read it. What do I find first? (2) Step 1: the groups. Multiply.
(3) Step 2: use my Step 1 answer. (4) Write the answer and the unit.

Zara has 4 boxes.
Each box has 7 crayons.
Zara gives away 9 crayons.
How many crayons does Zara have left?

Step 1

		7
×		4
2		8

Step 2

	1	18
	2	8
−		9
1		9

boxes
days
crayons

crayons

Tom has 6 jars.
Each jar has 4 stamps.
Tom gets 18 more stamps.
How many stamps does Tom have now?

Step 1

		6
×		4
2		4

Step 2

		1	
	2	4	
+	1	8	
	4	2	

jars
boxes
stamps

stamps

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Answer Key _____ **Date** _____

I Can solve two-step stories

Guided Practice: Circle the sign. Write the numbers in the boxes. Solve.

Steps: (1) Read it. What do I find first? (2) Step 1: share it. Divide.
(3) Step 2: use my Step 1 answer. (4) Write the answer and the unit.

Ana has 24 buttons.
Ana shares them equally among 6 friends.
Each friend gets 3 more.
How many buttons does each friend have now?

Step 1

+ − × **÷**

4
6) 2 4

Step 2

+ − × ÷

4
\+ 3
7

days
buttons
boxes

buttons

Zara has 30 books.
Zara shares them equally among 5 friends.
Each friend gives away 4.
How many books does each friend have now?

Step 1

+ − × **÷**

6
5) 3 0

Step 2

\+ **−** × ÷

6
\− 4
2

days
books
boxes

books

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Answer Key _____ **Date** _____ **Score** _____ /2

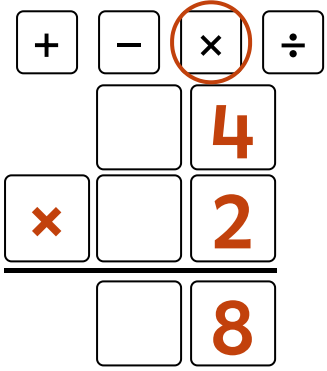
I Can solve two-step stories

Circle the sign. Write the numbers in the boxes. Solve.

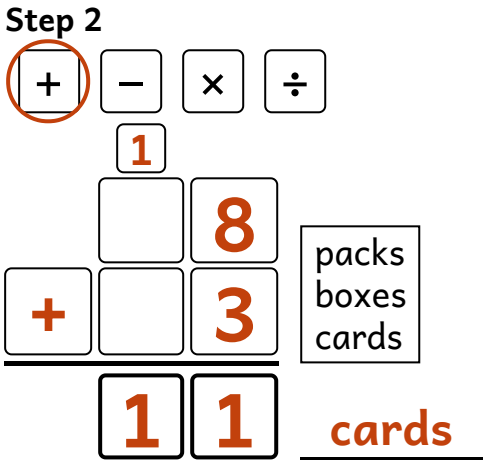
1

Kofi has 2 packs.
Each pack has 4 cards.
Kofi gets 3 more cards.
How many cards does Kofi have now?

Step 1



Step 2

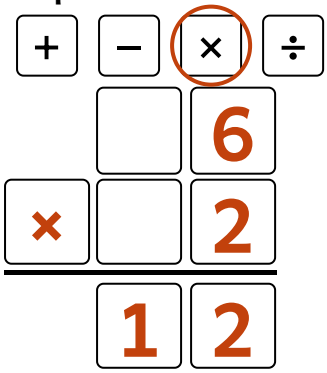


cards

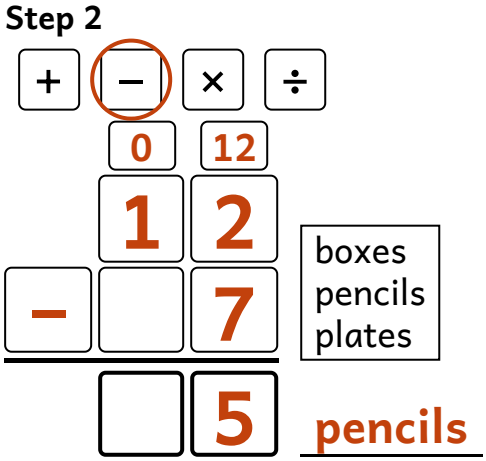
2

Zara has 2 plates.
Each plate has 6 pencils.
Zara gives away 7 pencils.
How many pencils does Zara have left?

Step 1



Step 2



pencils

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Answer Key _____ **Date** _____ **Score** _____ /2

I Can solve two-step stories

Circle the sign. Write the numbers in the boxes. Solve.

1

Tom has 20 marbles.
Tom shares them equally among 5 friends.
Each friend gives away 3.
How many marbles does each friend have now?

Step 1

+ − × **÷**

4
5) 2 0

Step 2

+ **−** × ÷

4
− 3
1

marble
boxes
days

marble

2

Kofi has 6 cookies.
Kofi shares them equally among 2 friends.
Each friend gets 8 more.
How many cookies does each friend have now?

Step 1

+ − × **÷**

3
2) 6

Step 2

+ − × ÷

1
3
\+ 8
1 1

cookies
boxes
days

cookies

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Answer Key _____ **Date** _____ **Score** _____ /1

I Can solve two-step stories

Read the story. Draw it. Solve.

Zara has 5 plates.

Each plate has 7 beads.

Zara gives away 10 beads.

How many beads are left?

The answer: 25 beads.

- ☐ Read it two times.
- ☐ Circle the numbers.
- ☐ Underline the question.
- ☐ Draw it.
- ☐ Write the equation.
- ☐ Solve. Check.

Workspace:

Step 1: 5 × 7 = 35

Step 2: 35 − 10 = 25

Say: "My Step 1 answer is 35 . Then I take away."

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Answer Key _____ Score _____ /2

I Can solve two-step stories

Read the story. Write each step. Solve.

1

Kofi has 2 boxes.
Each box has 8 books.
Kofi gives away 4 books.
How many books does Kofi have left?

Step 1: 2 × 8 = 16

Step 2: 16 − 4 = 12 **books**

2

Leo has 24 buttons.
Leo shares them equally among 3 friends.
Each friend gets 2 more.
How many buttons does each friend have now?

Step 1: 24 ÷ 3 = 8

Step 2: 8 + 2 = 10 **buttons**

Say: "Step 2 uses my Step 1 answer ."

☐ I can do this. ☐ I need one more day.

Answer Key _____ Score _____ /2

I Can solve two-step stories

Read the story. Write each step. Solve.

1

Kofi has 2 boxes.
Each box has 8 books.
Kofi gives away 4 books.
How many books does Kofi have left?

Step 1: 2 × 8 = 16

Step 2: 16 − 4 = 12 books

2

Leo has 24 buttons.
Leo shares them equally among 3 friends.
Each friend gets 2 more.
How many buttons does each friend have now?

Step 1: 24 ÷ 3 = 8

Step 2: 8 + 2 = 10 buttons

Say: "Step 2 uses my Step 1 answer ."

☐ I can do this. ☐ I need one more day.

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I Can solve two-step stories

Prerequisite routing:

Question	Prerequisite (T2 atom)	If missed → Lesson
1. Equal groups	Category, atom 2	3.OA.A.3 Equal-groups stories
2–3. Share equally	Category, atom 3	3.OA.A.3 Sharing stories
4. Two steps with + and −	Conceptual, atom 4	Y2 B4 S10 Two-step problems
	Rule	0 missed: go on · 1: that lesson · 2+: the earliest

Accepted answers:

- Step 1 for groups may be written either way round: 4 × 6 or 6 × 4.
- The unit word is from the bank; a missing unit with the right number: ask for it.
- P5: any drawing that shows the groups and the change, and both steps written.
- Step 1 right and Step 2 a slip of one: not yet right; ask the pupil to check Step 2.

Answers at a glance:

Page	Answers	Fade
P0 Prerequisite	**25 · 6 · 5 · 21**	★★
P1 Number sense	**57 · 10 · > · 3 tens 9 ones · 34 · 887 · 295 · < · 8 tens 4 ones · 104**	★★
P3 Guided	**19 · 42**	★
P3b Guided	**7 · 2**	★
P4-1 Practice, row 1	**11**	★★
P4-1 Practice, last row	**5**	★★★
P4-2 Practice, row 1	**1**	★★
P4-2 Practice, last row	**11**	★★★
P5 Word problem	**25 · 35 − 10 = 25**	★★
P6 Exit slip	**1. 12 · 2. 10**	★★

Wrong answers to look for when marking:

Pupil wrote	Likely mistake	Next step
16 (1)	**Stops after Step 1**	"Is that the question?" Read the last line.
4 (1)	**Story number in Step 2**	The arrow from Step 1 into Step 2.
8 (2)	**Stops after Step 1**	Point to the Step 2 box.
5 (2)	**Story number in Step 2**	Cups: one share first, then the change.

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